

The Upper Crust

The House of the States which has many businessmen on its rolls boasts of richer members. Of the 215 members who have filed their declaration, 105 have declared assets of over Rs 1 crore.

1 T. Subbarami Reddy Indian National Congress Andhra Pradesh

Total Assets
Rs 239.6 cr

He is an extraordinary networker whose frequent parties in Hyderabad, Mumbai and Delhi are grist to the political mill. At each of these, he casts the net wider to embrace people in all fields of human endeavour. The result: a humble contractor who built the world's biggest masonry dam at Nagarjunasagar, Andhra Pradesh, in the 1960s, has in less than four decades evolved into an active parliamentarian, dapper in kurta with koti, welcome to all groups within the Congress and outside. A commerce graduate from Hyderabad's Nizam College, he capitalised on investments through his Gayatri group in the infrastructure, steel, mines and power businesses across the country to offer jobs that in return brought him

and exhibitor, have brought many from Bollywood and the Telugu film industry closer to the Congress. He was a two-term member of the Lok Sabha—1996 and 1998—from Visakhapatnam and is now a Rajya Sabha member, and is credited with launching a number of community projects in the city. And in recognition of his social work, the University of Mangalore conferred a doctorate on him. As chairman of the Thirumala Tirupati Devasthanams (TTD) for two full terms—a rare distinction—he pioneered pro-pilgrim initiatives even as he encouraged his rich and famous friends to take time out for “wish fulfilling prayers at the hilltop shrine”. His wife, Indira, is on the TTD board, after his exit.

goodwill. His persuasive skills combined with his business interests, as film producer

by Amarnath K. Menon



BANDEEP SINGH